THE TUGHLAQS: MUHAMMAD BIN TUGHLAQ & FIRUZ SHAH

TUGHLAQ CHRONOLOGY AND EVIDENCE → THREE TUGHLAQ STATE STRATEGIES → MUHAMMAD'S PROBLEM OF IMPERIAL → FIVE EXPERIMENT CLUSTERS → DAULATABAD WITHOUT THE EMPTY-DELHI → TOKEN CURRENCY CREDIBILITY CHAIN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 TUGHLAQ CHRONOLOGY AND EVIDENCE SPINE

TUGHLAQ CHRONOLOGY AND EVIDENCE SPINE · 1320 GHIYASUDDIN · 1325 MUHAMMAD BIN TUGHLAQ · 1327-35 DAULATABAD PHASES · c.1329-33 TOKEN CURRENCY · 1330S DOAB CRISIS, CULTIVATION SCHEME AND REGIONAL REBELLIONS · 1351 FIRUZ SUCCEEDS DURING SINDH CAMPAIGN · 1388 FIRUZ DIES

1320 Ghiyasuddin → 1325 Muhammad bin Tughlaq → 1327-35 Daulatabad phases → c.1329-33 token currency → 1330s doab crisis, cultivation scheme and regional rebellions → 1351 Firuz succeeds during Sindh campaign → 1388 Firuz dies → EVIDENCE: Barani + Isami + Ibn Battuta + Afif + coins + canals + monuments

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1320 Ghiyasuddin → 1325 Muhammad bin Tughlaq
- 1327-35 Daulatabad phases → c.1329-33 token currency
- 1330s doab crisis, cultivation scheme and regional rebellions

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1351 Firuz succeeds during Sindh campaign → 1388 Firuz dies
- EVIDENCE: Barani + Isami + Ibn Battuta + Afif + coins + canals + monuments
- RULE: separate secure event, chronicler judgement and later legend.

IMPACT / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Daulatabad transfer, token currency and Doab taxation were separate experiments with different aims and outcomes.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: separate secure event, chronicler judgement and later legend.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: separate secure event, chronicler judgement and later legend.

01 THREE TUGHLAQ STATE STRATEGIES

THREE TUGHLAQ STATE STRATEGIES · MODERATED RESTORATION, CULTIVATION AND FRONTIER AUTHORITY · SCALE, UNIFORMITY, EXPERIMENTATION AND DIRECT SUPERVISION · CONCILIATION, HEREDITY, PUBLIC WORKS AND REDUCED MILITARY HORIZON · SHORT RUN · HIGH-RISK MOBILISATION · NEGOTIATED STABILITY · LONG RUN

SHORT RUN — restoration	high-risk mobilisation	negotiated stability
LONG RUN — unfinished consolidation	fragmentation	weaker central checks

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- GHIYASUDDIN → moderated restoration, cultivation and frontier authority
- MUHAMMAD → scale, uniformity, experimentation and direct supervision
- FIRUZ → conciliation, heredity, public works and reduced military horizon

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SHORT RUN → restoration
- high-risk mobilisation
- negotiated stability

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LONG RUN → unfinished consolidation
- weaker central checks
- VERDICT: compare objectives, instruments, costs and durability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LONG RUN → unfinished consolidation | fragmentation | weaker central checks.

02 MUHAMMAD'S PROBLEM OF IMPERIAL SCALE

MUHAMMAD'S PROBLEM OF IMPERIAL SCALE · FRONTIER RISK AND STRATEGIC AMBITION · GRAIN, REVENUE, MONEY AND ARMY PROVISIONING · DISTANCE, DIRECT RULE, DAULATABAD AND LOCAL RESISTANCE · GOVERNORS, ROUTES AND DELAYED COMMUNICATION · OLD NOBLES + FOREIGNERS + INDIAN CONVERTS + NEW · AMBITION OUTRAN INFORMATION, TRUST AND ENFORCEMENT CAPACITY.

NORTH-WEST → frontier risk and strategic ambition

DELHI-DOAB → grain, revenue, money and army provisioning → DECCAN → distance, direct rule, Daulatabad and local resistance → BENGAL / GUJARAT / SINDH → governors, routes and delayed communication

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WEST → frontier risk and strategic ambition
- DELHI-DOAB → grain, revenue, money and army provisioning

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- DECCAN → distance, direct rule, Daulatabad and local resistance
- BENGAL / GUJARAT / SINDH → governors, routes and delayed communication

DEBATE / LEGACY

- ELITES → old nobles + foreigners + Indian converts + new appointees
- DIAGNOSIS: ambition outran information, trust and enforcement capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECCAN → distance, direct rule, Daulatabad and local resistance.

03 FIVE EXPERIMENT CLUSTERS

FIVE EXPERIMENT CLUSTERS · SOUTHERN SUPERVISION · MIGRATION AND DUAL-CAPITAL LOGISTICS · TOKEN MONEY · MONETARY FLEXIBILITY · AUTHENTICATION AND REDEMPTION · DOAB RESET · HIGHER DEPENDABLE REVENUE

DAULATABAD → southern supervision → migration and dual-capital logistics → TOKEN MONEY → monetary flexibility → authentication and redemption → DOAB RESET → higher dependable revenue

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DAULATABAD → southern supervision
- migration and dual-capital logistics
- TOKEN MONEY → monetary flexibility
- authentication and redemption

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- DOAB RESET → higher dependable revenue
- assessment and famine resilience
- DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI → cultivation
- credit and honest supervision

DEBATE / LEGACY

- KHURASAN / QARACHIL → frontier initiative
- finance, terrain and intelligence
- TEST EACH: rational aim → required instrument → implementation failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST EACH: rational aim → required instrument → implementation failure.

04 DAULATABAD WITHOUT THE EMPTY-DELHI MYTH

DAULATABAD WITHOUT THE EMPTY-DELHI MYTH · SECOND CAPITAL + DECCAN SUPERVISION + NORTH-SOUTH COMMUNICATION · COURT + OFFICIALS + NOBLES + SCHOLARS/SUFIS + MERCHANTS/ARTISANS · PRESSURED MOVEMENT AND HARDSHIP REMAINED REAL · DELHI RETAINED PEOPLE, MINTING AND POLITICAL FUNCTION · RETURN AND SOUTHERN BREAKAWAYS CHANGED THE PROJECT'S PURPOSE · SOURCE RULE · ISAMI'S DISPLACEMENT NARRATIVE IS VITAL BUT POSITIONED.

OBJECTIVE → second capital + Deccan supervision + north-south communication → AFFECTED → court + officials + nobles + scholars/Sufis + merchants/artisans → COERCION → pressured movement and hardship remained real → CONTINUITY → Delhi retained people, minting and political function → REVERSAL → return and southern breakaways changed the project's purpose

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OBJECTIVE → second capital + Deccan supervision + north-south communication
- AFFECTED → court + officials + nobles + scholars/Sufis + merchants/artisans

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COERCION → pressured movement and hardship remained real
- CONTINUITY → Delhi retained people, minting and political function

DEBATE / LEGACY

- REVERSAL → return and southern breakaways changed the project's purpose
- SOURCE RULE → Isami's displacement narrative is vital but positioned.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOURCE RULE → Isami's displacement narrative is vital but positioned.

05 TOKEN CURRENCY CREDIBILITY CHAIN

TOKEN CURRENCY CREDIBILITY CHAIN · STATE ASSIGNS COPPER · BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE SUCCESS REQUIRES MINT CONTROL · PRIVATE IMITATION AND COUNTERFEIT EXPANSION TRUST COLLAPSES · REDEMPTION BURDEN · MONETARY DESIGN FAILED THROUGH ENFORCEMENT AND CREDIBILITY GAPS.

STATE ASSIGNS COPPER / BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE success requires mint control + recognisable burden. → tax acceptance weak verification → private imitation and counterfeit expansion trust collapses → redemption burden → LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- STATE ASSIGNS COPPER / BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE success requires mint control + recognisable standard +
- tax acceptance weak verification → private imitation and counterfeit expansion trust collapses → redemption burden → withdrawal

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.
- STATE ASSIGNS COPPER / BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE success requires mint control + recognisable standard +

DEBATE / LEGACY

- tax acceptance weak verification → private imitation and counterfeit expansion trust collapses → redemption burden → withdrawal
- LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.

06 DOAB CRISIS AND AGRARIAN REPAIR

DOAB CRISIS AND AGRARIAN REPAIR · STANDARD YIELD · OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND HARSH COLLECTION + FAMINE · FLIGHT, RESISTANCE AND REBELLION · SONDHAR LOANS + DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI CULTIVATION PROGRAMME CORRUPTION, WEAK MONITORING · SEPARATE FISCAL OBJECTIVE, COLLECTOR BEHAVIOUR AND CLIMATE.

STANDARD YIELD / OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND harsh collection + famine stress → flight → SONDHAR loans + DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI cultivation programme corruption, weak monitoring and over-ambitious scale limit recovery → RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- STANDARD YIELD / OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND harsh collection + famine stress → flight, resistance and rebellion
- SONDHAR loans + DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI cultivation programme corruption, weak monitoring and over-ambitious scale limit recovery

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.
- STANDARD YIELD / OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND harsh collection + famine stress → flight, resistance and rebellion

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SONDHAR loans + DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI cultivation programme corruption, weak monitoring and over-ambitious scale limit recovery
- RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.

07 KHURASAN AND QARACHIL SEPARATED

KHURASAN AND QARACHIL SEPARATED · KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION NORTH-WEST STRATEGIC OPENING HIMALAYAN FRONTIER · COMMON LIMIT · STRATEGIC AMBITION EXCEEDED SUSTAINABLE LOGISTICS.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply	COMMON LIMIT: strategic ambition exceeded sustainable logistics.	problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China
problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China	KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply	COMMON LIMIT: strategic ambition exceeded sustainable logistics.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply
- problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COMMON LIMIT: strategic ambition exceeded sustainable logistics.
- KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply

DEBATE / LEGACY

- problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China
- COMMON LIMIT: strategic ambition exceeded sustainable logistics.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China.

08 READING THE TUGHLAQ ARCHIVE

READING THE TUGHLAQ ARCHIVE · POLICY DETAIL AND ELITE CRITICISM · LATER, NORMATIVE, ARISTOCRATIC · DAULATABAD/DECCAN DISPLACEMENT · HOSTILE POLITICAL LOCATION · IBN BATTUTA · EYEWITNESS COURT/TRAVEL · DRAMATIC LITERARY CONVENTIONS

BARANI → policy detail and elite criticism	later, normative, aristocratic
ISAMI → Daulatabad/Deccan displacement	hostile political location
IBN BATTUTA → eyewitness court/travel	dramatic literary conventions
AFIF / FUTUHAT → Firuz institutions	praise and self-fashioning
LATER CHRONICLES → memory	cannot certify exact totals
COINS / CANALS / MONUMENTS → material checks	uneven survival

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BARANI → policy detail and elite criticism
- later, normative, aristocratic
- ISAMI → Daulatabad/Deccan displacement
- hostile political location
- IBN BATTUTA → eyewitness court/travel

METHOD / DEBATE

- dramatic literary conventions
- AFIF / FUTUHAT → Firuz institutions
- praise and self-fashioning
- LATER CHRONICLES → memory
- cannot certify exact totals

HISTORICAL RESULT

- COINS / CANALS / MONUMENTS → material checks
- uneven survival
- METHOD: intent + report + implementation + region + later stereotype.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: METHOD: intent + report + implementation + region + later stereotype.

09 FIRUZ'S CONCILIATION BARGAIN

FIRUZ'S CONCILIATION BARGAIN · SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON NOBLE SALARIES AND LIGHTER AUDITS + · CLOSE DISTINCTION · FAILURE MUST NOT BE REDUCED TO A TIMELESS 'MAD

SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas → soldier wajh claims + ulema support + reduced punitive intensity short-term peace and → elite compliance long-term oligarchic closure, localised army and weaker central discipline. → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Failure must not be reduced to a timeless 'mad king' label; design, enforcement

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas
- soldier wajh claims + ulema support + reduced punitive intensity short-term peace and

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- elite compliance long-term oligarchic closure, localised army and weaker central discipline.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Failure must not be reduced to a timeless 'mad king' label; design, enforcement, ecology and source hostility matter.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas
- soldier wajh claims + ulema support + reduced punitive intensity short-term peace and

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Failure must not be reduced to a timeless 'mad king' label; design, enforcement, ecology and source hostility matter.

10 WORKS, WELFARE, SLAVERY AND ORTHODOXY

WORKS, WELFARE, SLAVERY AND ORTHODOXY · CULTIVATION AND REVENUE IN THE NORTHERN CORE · URBAN PATRONAGE AND DYNASTIC DISPLAY · BOUNDED WELFARE CLAIMS · EMPLOYMENT REPORTS · CHRONICLER EVIDENCE, NOT A MODERN LABOUR OFFICE · COERCED SERVICE AND LATER FACTIONAL RISK · ORTHODOXY WITH CASE-SPECIFIC EVIDENCE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CANALS / HAQQ-I-SHARB → cultivation and revenue in the northern core	EMPLOYMENT REPORTS → chronicler evidence, not a modern labour office	PILLARS / TRANSLATIONS → conservation, appropriation and learned exchange.
TOWNS / GARDENS / KOTLA → urban patronage and dynastic display	DIWAN-I-BANDAGAN → coerced service and later factional risk	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Firuz Shah's canals, charities, slavery and religious policy require a combined fiscal, social and political reading.
HOSPITAL / EDUCATION / DIWAN-I-KHAIRAT → bounded welfare claims	JIZYA / BRAHMANS / ULAMA → orthodoxy with case-specific evidence	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CANALS / HAQQ-I-SHARB → cultivation and revenue in the northern core
- TOWNS / GARDENS / KOTLA → urban patronage and dynastic display
- HOSPITAL / EDUCATION / DIWAN-I-KHAIRAT → bounded welfare claims

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- EMPLOYMENT REPORTS → chronicler evidence, not a modern labour office
- DIWAN-I-BANDAGAN → coerced service and later factional risk
- JIZYA / BRAHMANS / ULAMA → orthodoxy with case-specific evidence

DEBATE / LEGACY

- PILLARS / TRANSLATIONS → conservation, appropriation and learned exchange.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Firuz Shah's canals, charities, slavery and religious policy require a combined fiscal, social and political reading.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Firuz Shah's canals, charities, slavery and religious policy require a combined fiscal, social and political reading.

11 TOPIC 05 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 05 ANSWER SPINE · TUGHLAQ HISTORY IS A TEST OF STATE CAPACITY, NOT · GHIYASUDDIN'S RESTORATION AND AN UNUSUALLY LARGE INHERITED EMPIRE · AIM, INSTRUMENT, FAILURE MODE AND UNEVEN AFTERLIFE OF EACH · CONCILIATION, WORKS AND WELFARE BALANCED AGAINST HEREDITY AND ORTHODOXY · COMPARE CHRONICLERS WITH COINS, CANALS, INSCRIPTIONS AND MONUMENTS · OVER-CENTRALISATION AND NEGOTIATED DEVOLUTION PRODUCED DIFFERENT FRAGILITIES.

OPEN → Tughlaq history is a test of state capacity, not eccentricity alone → CONTEXT → Ghiyasuddin's restoration and an unusually large inherited empire → MUHAMMAD → aim, instrument, failure mode and uneven afterlife of each project → FIRUZ → conciliation, works and welfare balanced against heredity and orthodoxy → SOURCES → compare chroniclers with coins, canals, inscriptions and monuments

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OPEN → Tughlaq history is a test of state capacity, not eccentricity alone
- CONTEXT → Ghiyasuddin's restoration and an unusually large inherited empire

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- MUHAMMAD → aim, instrument, failure mode and uneven afterlife of each project
- FIRUZ → conciliation, works and welfare balanced against heredity and orthodoxy

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SOURCES → compare chroniclers with coins, canals, inscriptions and monuments
- CLOSE → over-centralisation and negotiated devolution produced different fragilities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → over-centralisation and negotiated devolution produced different fragilities.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE TUGHLAQS · MUHAMMAD BIN TUGHLAQ & FIRUZ SHAH — ADVANCED · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · 5. UPSC TRAPS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- The Tughlaqs: Muhammad bin Tughlaq & Firuz Shah — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- « Concept: "Second capital," not "capital transfer"
- The exodus to Deogiri/Daulatabad was not a total emptying of Delhi.
- It mainly involved the royal household, nobles, officials, Sufis, ulema, merchants and artisans

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels